

Crowdfunding

Crowdfunding lets your customers and community fund your business — often before you've sold a thing. Below are the main platforms and tips. Tick the box once you've explored each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

There are different types of crowdfunding: rewards, loans, and equity. Pick the one that fits, and read each platform's fees before you start. Most charge a percentage only if you succeed.

1 Rewards Crowdfunding

Supporters give money in exchange for a product or perk — great for launching.

☐ Kickstarter

All-or-nothing funding for creative products and launches.

→ www.kickstarter.com

☐ Indiegogo

Flexible funding for products, ideas, and small businesses.

→ www.indiegogo.com

2 Loan-Based Crowdfunding

Borrow from a crowd, often at low or zero interest.

☐ Kiva — 0% Interest

Crowdfunded loans up to \$15,000 at 0% interest, no credit score required.

→ www.kiva.org/borrow

3 Equity Crowdfunding

Sell small shares of your business to many investors (legally regulated).

☐ StartEngine

Raise investment from the public by selling equity.

→ www.startengine.com

☐ Wefunder

Equity crowdfunding for startups and small businesses.

→ wefunder.com

4 Run a Strong Campaign

Preparation is the difference between funded and not.

☐ Plan Before You Launch

Most successful campaigns line up early supporters first, use a clear video, and set a realistic goal. A SCORE mentor can review your plan free.

→ www.score.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Read the fee structure and rules before launching — some platforms keep nothing if you miss your goal (all-or-nothing), others take a cut regardless. Never use a platform that asks for big upfront fees.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Line up your first 20–30% of funding from friends and fans before you go public — campaigns with early momentum are far more likely to hit their goal.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national platforms. For local crowdfunding help and matching programs, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
